

live. His first thought was the welfare of his men; his second for his friends and associates; and his last—and least—for himself. He was always a strict disciplinarian, exacting from his subordinates the same deference and courtesy that he never failed to show his superiors.

With the close of the war and the muster out of the regiment, Major Schaeffer returned to civil life. In December, 1898, he was appointed Chief of Police by the newly elected Mayor of Minneapolis, but not finding the office congenial, he declined the appointment, and in January of the following year he entered the office of the County Auditor of Hennepin County and remained there until his death.

He died on June 23, 1900, leaving a widow and one child. During his brief career he proved himself one of the bravest soldiers that ever fought under the folds of the flag he loved so well—at all times a gallant soldier, a chivalrous gentleman, and a man whose friends were limited only by the number of those who knew him.

E. B. SMITH.

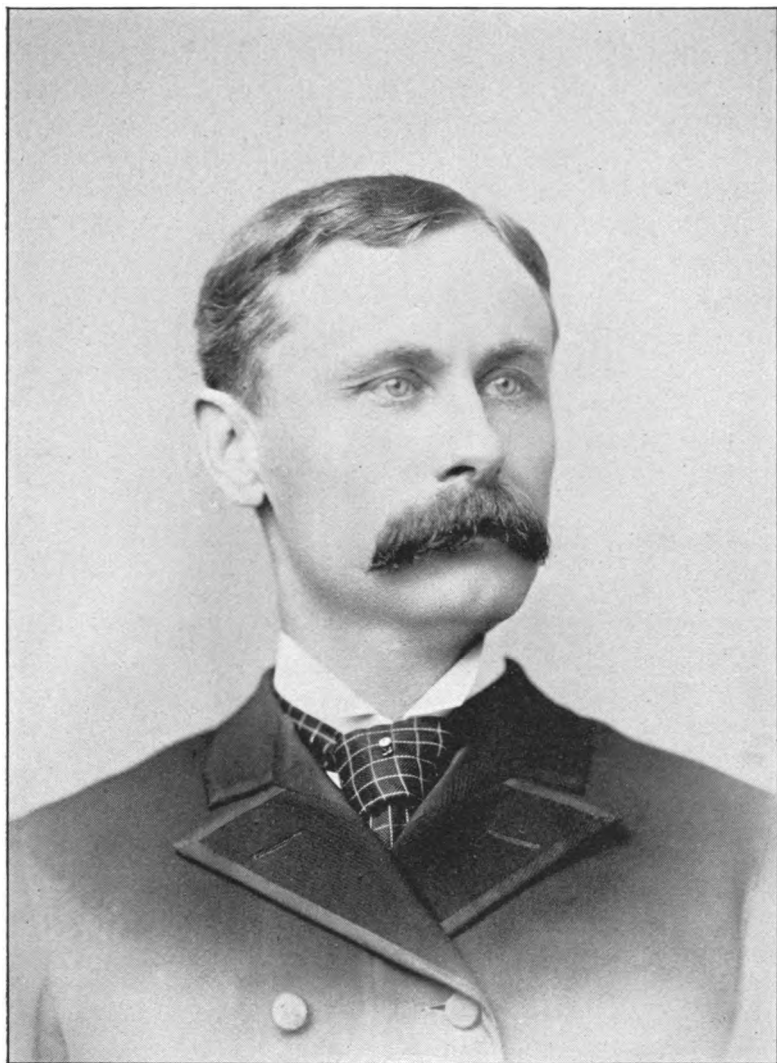
JAMES ALFRED DENNISON.

No. 2324. CLASS OF 1870.

Died, July 12, 1900, at New York City, aged 54.

JAMES ALFRED DENNISON was born in Indiana in 1846, and when twelve years of age accompanied his parents to Missouri, which State he represented at the Academy. The records show that he was Cadet from September 1, 1866, to July 15, 1870, when he was graduated and promoted to Second Lieutenant, Second United States Artillery.

After three months' service with that regiment, he was transferred to the Eighth United States Cavalry, on October 8, 1871, serving at Fort Union and Fort Bascom, New Mexico.



COLONEL JAMES A. DENNISON.

He resigned August 31, 1872, and, after a distinguished career, died at New York City, N. Y., of pneumonia, on July 12, 1900.

His patriotic services began at sixteen, when he enlisted in the Fifteenth Missouri Volunteer Infantry, serving in the War of the Rebellion from '61 to '62, in that regiment, with his father and two brothers.

Re-enlisting in the Eighth Missouri Cavalry, he served loyally until the end of the war.

It was in this arduous early campaigning that he, like many other boy soldiers, seriously impaired his health. A notable early death rate has followed the young men sent from the army to fill the then vacant cadetships of the southern districts.

After a year's preparation at Mount Vernon College, Iowa, young Dennison was appointed by Congressman Kelso, and was a classmate of General Francis Vinton Greene and other brilliant soldiers. No more energetic or loyal soul ever left "Benny Havens, oh!" than Dennison, every inch a soldier.

On resigning from the army, he entered the Albany Law School, and was admitted to the bar in '73, beginning his law practice at Little Falls, New York, which was, later, continued at Johnstown, New York, and New York City.

Ardently desiring active service, in '74 he went to Egypt, and, on New Year's day, '75, was appointed Major of Engineers in the Khedive's army, under General C. P. Stone, later being promoted to General Instructor of Engineers with the rank of Colonel, and serving twice in invasions of Abyssinia.

His career in Egypt was both soldierly and brilliant. Second in command with Count Arendorp, he had an independent force under his control, which he fought with honor, saving all the troops and material brought back from an ill-starred foray in the face of overwhelming force.

The writer, who organized the delayed expedition, and was to have led it, gave, as his last words to Arendorp, (a gallant Dane,) on leaving Egypt: "If you divide your forces in the face

of the enemy, you will lose your head!" A prediction which was but too literally fulfilled.

Count Arendorp, an ex-Aide-de-Camp of the King of Denmark, left Major Dennison on a hill with orders to build a redoubt, guard the stores, hold communication open, and attacking rashly he, with more than half the command, was massacred. The brave American repulsed two later attacks, destroyed the useless cannon and spare stores, and then fought his command to the coast, saving it and the honor of the crescent flag.

For this, as a scape-goat was needed, he was, for some time, in danger of his life from the brutal resentment of the incapable Egyptian "palace" Generals.

But, winning his way, he did loyal service later in the great campaign which ended in the rout of Gura, through the abject cowardice of Prince Hassan, sent up to receive his "baptism of fire," which he avoided by a four-mile heat, the best on record.

Generals Loring, Dye, Colonel Dennison, and other Americans, with the heroic conduct of one brave Egyptian artilleryman, fighting a steel Krupp battery, saved the wreck of a magnificent force.

Cool, calm and resolute, in the aggregate, Colonel Dennison got better service out of the Egyptians than any man, save Generals Dye, Purdy, Colonel Prout and Chaill Long, all operating on the well known lines of our frontier tactics.

The downfall of Ismail, and Chinese Gordon's aversion to Americans, brought Colonel Dennison, covered with laurels, and yet, practically unrewarded, back to America. The later English policy, as developed by time, shows why the "Americans were honorably" hastened out of the country. They were the only men loyal to Egypt in the whole polyglot force.

Returning in 1876, Colonel Dennison married Miss Ella Dudley, a daughter of Judge Dudley, and began the practice of law at Johnstown. Removing to New York City, he opened an office at 32 Nassau Street, achieving a success as a lawyer seldom vouchsafed to the West Pointer.

The Washington Trust Company, John H. Starin, and others, were leading clients.

Colonel Dennison was Assistant Attorney General of the State of New York, with Leslie W. Russell, being defeated as Attorney General on the Republican ticket, in 1887.

Colonel Frederick Kopper brought Dennison into the Seventy-first Regiment, New York National Guards, as Lieutenant Colonel, in which capacity he served till 1893, his services being very valuable to the force.

Under the fatigues of an early and varied military life, and the strain of a profession to which he was ardently attached, the soldier-lawyer gradually lost health, until an apparently trifling cold led to the fatal termination of his long illness.

An interesting family of a wife and three children (two sons and a married daughter) survive the subject of this sketch, all resident at Johnstown, N. Y.

Colonel Dennison was an esteemed member of Lafayette Post, G. A. R., in New York City, and was a lineal descendant of Commodore Perry.

Still in the prime of his intellect at fifty-four, Colonel Dennison was a man of soldierly presence, of varied gifts, and one who had served gallantly and loyally "under two flags."

As cadet, officer, National Guardsman, in his high rank abroad, and, at the bar, James A. Dennison was noted for courtesy, quick comprehension, a calm, unshaken intellect, and an unusual aptitude for the legal profession.

It is no light tribute, paid by one of the ablest lawyers of New York City, the sorrowing remark, "He had a fine legal mind, and was a man of consummate and comprehensive ability."

To those who knew and loved him, his comparatively early death leaves a void not easily filled, and the record of his adventurous career is an honorable and varied one.

Personally attached to him, I always respect the soldierly fortitude with which Colonel Dennison refrained from exposing

the callous neglect and brutal treatment of the distinguished American officers in Egypt, who "plowed where others reaped, later," who brought from the field the only honors ever gained under the nondescript Egyptian flag, and who, as a body, received the meed of the neglected soldier, "ingratitude and oblivion."

But, while the explorations of Purdy, Chaillè Long, Prout, Dye and others forced a new geography of the Soudan into general use, and "made the way smooth" for the "Soldiers of the Queen," the alumni of West Point should never forget their lonely comrade, on that Abyssinian hill, who "held the fort," and brought back his shield with honor. "It is not for him who putteth on the armour to boast like him who taketh it off."

Long and weary is the path to fame as a soldier, or distinction at the bar. James Alfred Dennison achieved much in life, and reflected credit upon his family, his State, his Alma Mater and his country.

A loyal friend, a kind husband and father, a gallant soldier, and a true and unselfish patriot, he has "gone to where beyond these voices there is peace."

And it is not without a generous throb of the heart that I say "Farewell" to my friend and comrade, who, like myself, has camped "on the sandy banks of the Rio Grande," and "drank the waters of old Nile.

RICHARD HENRY SAVAGE, CLASS OF 1868.

JULIUS HAYDEN PARDEE.

No. 2410. CLASS OF 1871.

Died, July 13, 1900, near Beenham, Union County, New Mexico, aged 52.

PARDEE came from Oswego, N. Y., where his people still live, to enter the Military Academy in 1867. After his graduation in 1871 he saw a great deal of service on the frontier in the southwest and in the northwest.